CHAPTER 10

HUMAN SETTLEMENTS

CHAPTER ESSENCE AT A GLANCE:
Examine the classification of rural settlements (clustered, semi-clustered, hamleted, dispersed), historical evolution of urban settlements (ancient, medieval, modern), functional classification of Indian cities, and urban agglomerations.

4 CORE PRINCIPLES TO UNDERSTAND FIRST

• **Rural Settlement Typology:** Four distinct types: Clustered (compact living area, fertile northern plains), Semi-clustered (social segregation, dominant caste nucleus), Hamleted (physically fragmented units like panna, para, palli), and Dispersed (isolated homesteads in hills).

• **Evolution of Indian Towns:** Ancient towns (over 2,000 years old, religious cultural roots: Varanasi, Prayagraj, Madurai), Medieval towns (fortified royal capitals: Delhi, Hyderabad, Agra), and Modern towns (British colonial ports and planned post-independence hubs: Mumbai, Chandigarh, Bhilai).

• **Functional Classification of Towns:** Indian towns specialize in distinct dominant activities: Administrative (New Delhi, Chandigarh), Industrial (Bhilai, Jamshedpur), Mining (Raniganj, Jharia), Cantonment (Ambala), Transport (Kandla), and Educational or Religious.

• **Urban Agglomerations and Census Towns:** An Urban Agglomeration consists of a core town and its continuous urban outgrowths. A Census Town must meet statutory criteria: minimum 5,000 population, 75 percent male workers in non-agriculture, and 400 persons per sq km density.

ESSENTIAL GEOGRAPHICAL MODELS & LANDFORMS

$$\text{Clustered Rural Settlement} \iff \text{Compact Nucleated Dwellings} + \text{Central Living Space}$$

Nucleated Clustered Village Architecture

$$\text{Dispersed Rural Settlement} \iff \text{Isolated Homesteads} + \text{Fragmented Mountain Farms}$$

Dispersed Isolated Habitat Morphology

$$\text{Urban Agglomeration (UA)} \iff \text{Core Town} + \text{Contiguous Outgrowths or Satellite Towns}$$

Metropolitan Urban Agglomeration Matrix

$$\text{Evolutionary Urban Typology} \iff \text{Ancient Cities} \rightarrow \text{Medieval Fort Towns} \rightarrow \text{Modern Colonial Ports}$$

Historical Evolution of Indian Urbanism

CRUCIAL EXAM PRECAUTIONS & VALUATION RUBRIC SECRETS

• **Alert:** Hamleted settlements are physically separated clusters that share a common revenue village identity, whereas semi-clustered settlements reflect social exclusion and caste-based spatial segregation.

• **Alert:** Chandigarh and Gandhinagar are planned modern administrative towns built after independence, not colonial ports or medieval garrison fortresses.

• **Alert:** A settlement is designated as a Census Town when it has at least 5,000 people, 75 percent of male main workers in non-agricultural activities, and a density of at least 400 persons per sq km.

HIGH-YIELD CENTUM QUESTIONS & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS

1. Explain the four major types of rural settlements found in India with regional examples. [Score: 4 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **1. Clustered Settlements:** Compact, closely built houses with a distinct living area separated from surrounding farms; prevalent in fertile alluvial plains of Northern India and Bundelkhand. **[1 Mark]**

• **2. Semi-Clustered Settlements:** Result from spatial segregation; the landowning dominant caste occupies the central village while landless lower castes live on the periphery; seen in Gujarat and Rajasthan plains. **[1 Mark]**

• **3. Hamleted Settlements:** Physically fragmented into distinct units known locally as panna, para, palli, nagla, and dhani; common in the middle and lower Ganga plains. **[1 Mark]**

• **4. Dispersed Settlements:** Isolated huts or homesteads scattered over rugged hills and remote forests; found in Meghalaya, Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, and Kerala. **[1 Mark]**

2. Classify Indian towns on the basis of their historical evolution (Ancient, Medieval, and Modern towns) with two examples of each. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Ancient Towns:** Towns with historical continuity of over 2,000 years, developed as religious and cultural centres (for example, Varanasi, Prayagraj, and Pataliputra or Patna). **[1 Mark]**

• **Medieval Towns:** Emerged as fortified administrative capitals and headquarters of principalities and sultanates (for example, Delhi, Hyderabad, Agra, and Jaipur). **[1 Mark]**

• **Modern Towns:** Developed by European colonial rulers as trading ports and hill stations, and planned post-independence industrial centres (for example, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Chandigarh, and Bhilai). **[1 Mark]**

3. Provide the functional classification of Indian towns with suitable examples for any four categories. [Score: 4 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **1. Administrative Towns:** Headquarters of national or state governments (for example, New Delhi, Chandigarh, and Gandhinagar). **[1 Mark]**

• **2. Industrial Towns:** Dominated by manufacturing and processing plants (for example, Bhilai, Jamshedpur, and Modinagar). **[1 Mark]**

• **3. Mining Towns:** Developed in mineral-rich belts for mineral extraction (for example, Raniganj, Jharia, and Digboi). **[1 Mark]**

• **4. Religious and Cultural Towns:** Renowned pilgrimage and temple centres (for example, Varanasi, Tirupati, Puri, and Ajmer). **[1 Mark]**

4. What is an urban agglomeration? Mention the three combinations that constitute an urban agglomeration in India. [Score: 3 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Definition:** A continuous, unbroken urban spread consisting of a core town and its adjoining urban outgrowths. **[1 Mark]**

• **Three Constituent Types:** (a) A town and its adjoining urban outgrowths; (b) Two or more contiguous towns with or without their outgrowths; (c) A city and one or more adjoining towns with their outgrowths forming a continuous urban fabric. **[2 Marks]**

5. State the three demographic and economic criteria used by the Census of India to identify a Census Town. [Score: 2 Marks]

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **1. Minimum Population:** A minimum total population of 5,000 persons. **[0.5 Mark]**

• **2. Non-Agricultural Male Workforce:** At least 75 percent of the male main working population engaged in non-agricultural pursuits. **[1 Mark]**

• **3. Density Threshold:** A population density of at least 400 persons per square kilometer. **[0.5 Mark]**

6. Describe the factors that give rise to dispersed or isolated settlements in the mountainous and forested tracts of India. **[Score: 3 Marks]**

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Dissected Topography:** Extremely rugged terrain and steep slopes prevent the formation of large contiguous cultivated tracts, forcing homesteads to remain fragmented. **[1 Mark]**

• **Scattered Water and Arable Pockets:** Isolated farmsteads establish around tiny perennial natural springs or terraced valley patches. **[1 Mark]**

• **Regional Distribution:** Widespread across the Himalayas, Meghalaya plateau, Uttarakhand, and plantation estates in Kerala. **[1 Mark]**

7. Differentiate between clustered rural settlements and hamleted rural settlements. **[Score: 2 Marks]**

Answer & Key Valuation Steps:

• **Clustered Settlements:** Houses are tightly packed together into a continuous compact block with narrow lanes and a centralized community area. **[1 Mark]**

• **Hamleted Settlements:** The village is physically divided into several scattered hamlets bearing local names, but all share a single administrative identity. **[1 Mark]**